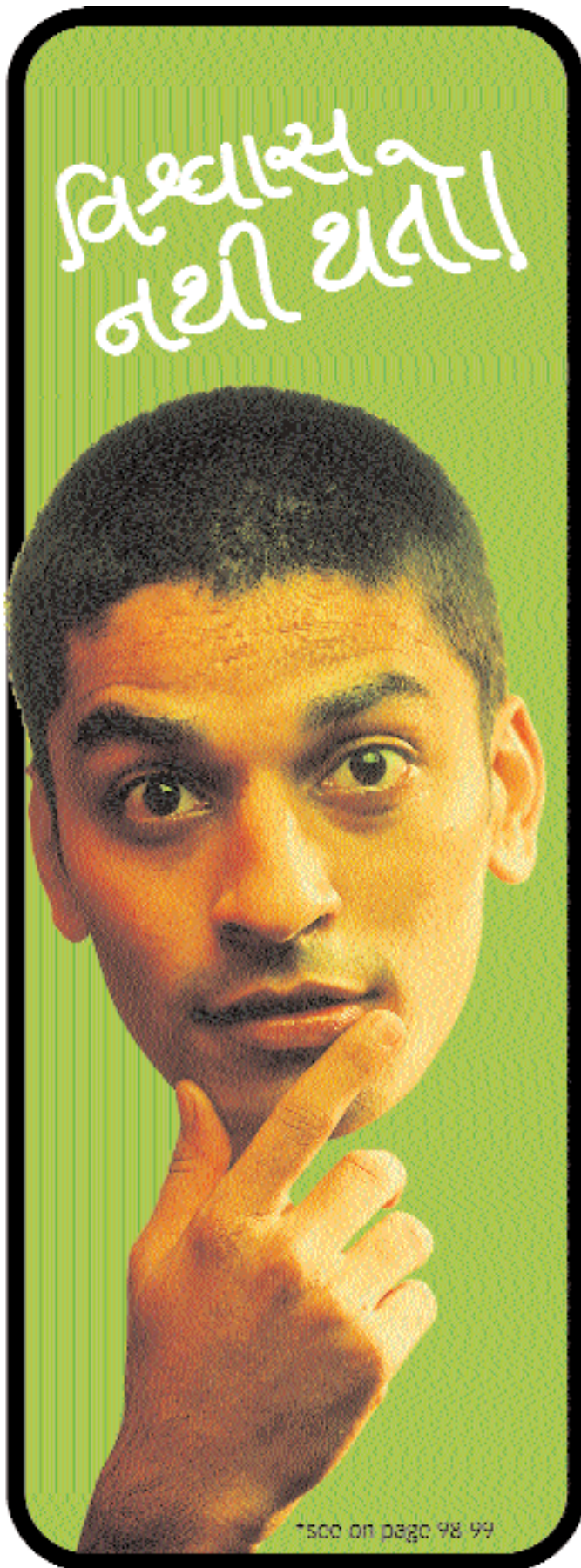




graphics card will definitely boost the video quality in a big way. Since you want one only for movies, a GeForce2 MX 16 MB card is a good choice, as it will offer good value for money. What's more, you will also be able to play demanding games, such as *Quake III* and *Unreal Tournament*, which may change your attitude towards gaming.

Remove that Buzz

Q I recently bought a Toshiba Satellite laptop with a Pentium 4 1.8 GHz, 256 MB DDR RAM, 30 GB hard drive and an internal modem, running Windows XP. I face with two problems. First, when I use the modem to connect to the Net, it dials the number properly, but makes an extra beep when activated. It occurs at regular intervals of about 3 seconds and the laptop shows the message, "The phone line is busy". I have tried changing the number, the telephone line and also reinstalled the modem driver, but to no avail.



Setting the phone line for Pulse Dialing

I also want to connect this laptop to my home PC that has a NIC and runs Windows XP. I failed to connect using the NIC and tried the wizard, as well as manual configuration. How can I solve these problems?

Jitesh M K

A You might have configured the dialing pattern as 'Tone' in your Dialing Properties. Many telephone connections still do not have the facility for Tone

dial. To change the dialing mechanism go to Control Panel > Modems > Dialing Properties. Now change the 'Dial using' to Pulse dial.

To transfer files from your laptop to your PC, you need to connect them via a network. You need to have network cards in both, the laptop and the PC, and connect them with a cross-linked cable. To create a cross cable, connect pin 1 and pin 2 at one end, to pin 3 and pin 6 at the other end, respectively. As you are connecting only two computers, further configuration is not required, just connect the cables and you will be up and running.

Transfer on the move

Q I have a Mobile with an IrDA port, which I want to connect to my computer. The problem is, my computer doesn't have an IrDA port. Do I need an IrDA port, and what will it cost me? My computer is an IBM Net vista, with four USB ports.

Chaiatny Sharan

A As you do not have an IrDA port on your computer, you need to get an IrDA device. IrDA devices are external devices that connect to the computer via the USB port or even the serial port. These devices are available, but expensive and cost about Rs 5,000. If you are serious about using IrDA, upgrade to one of the latest motherboards, which have the infra-red facility.

Cassettes to MP3

Q I have many audio cassettes. Is there any way I can convert the songs on them in to the MP3 format and store them on CD's?

Rajat